



FUEL WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 5 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 11 SEPTEMBER 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Fuel risk was High this week. The main pressure came from the Strait of Hormuz backdrop and a refinery disruption in Saudi Arabia, while reported shortages in Russia and tighter fuel-product balances elsewhere added continuity pressure beyond simple price moves. Market signals reinforced that pattern: Brent rose to 104.42 USD/bbl, WTI rose to 99.99 USD/bbl, and jet fuel rose to 4.341 USD/gal.

FAST FACTS

BRENT CRUDE

104.4 USD/bbl

+8.5% 7d

ICE Brent front-month (Yahoo Finance)

As of 11 Sep 2026

WTI CRUDE

99.99 USD/bbl

+9.3% 7d

NYMEX WTI front-month (Yahoo Finance)

As of 11 Sep 2026

JET FUEL

4.341 USD/gal

+5.4% 7d

U.S. Gulf Coast kerosene-type · EIA / FRED

As of 9 Sep 2026

Reporting-period coverage

2026-09-05 to 2026-09-11

DISTINCT DEVELOPMENTS

17

Evidence-family-deduplicated

ACTIVE COUNTRIES

5

With an attributed development

SEVERITY DISTRIBUTION

Insignificant

Low

Moderate

High

Extreme

0

6

10

1

0

05 Sep

06 Sep

07 Sep

08 Sep

09 Sep

10 Sep

11 Sep

1

0

2

3

5

1

5

DAILY INCIDENT TREND

05 Sep

06 Sep

07 Sep

08 Sep

09 Sep

10 Sep

11 Sep

1

0

2

3

5

1

5

AFFECTED COUNTRIES — DISTINCT DEVELOPMENT COUNT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	HIGHEST SEVERITY	SEVERITY DETAIL
Iran	4	MODERATE	Moderate 4
Russia	3	LOW	Low 3
Pakistan	2	MODERATE	Moderate 2
India	1	LOW	Low 1
Saudi Arabia	1	HIGH	High 1
Unattributed	6	MODERATE	Low 2 · Moderate 4

Coverage is limited to current-period Fuel-relevant records that passed the relevance and evidence-family gates; syndicated, commentary and follow-on coverage is not counted as a separate development. Country rows are ordered by development count, not ranked for impact, and this is not a full raw-ingest total.

JET FUEL PRICE TRAJECTORY

U.S. Gulf Coast kerosene-type jet fuel (USD/gal)

Latest 09 Sep: **4.34** USD/gal



U.S. Gulf Coast kerosene-type jet fuel, 6 observations from 01 Sep to 09 Sep.

Jet fuel latest available 9 Sep 2026 (daily EIA U.S. Gulf Coast series, publication trails the crude close); Brent and WTI run to 11 Sep 2026 (the period end).

MARKET READ

Brent crude is rising against a undated reference with no date; WTI crude is rising against a undated reference with no date; Jet fuel is rising within the reporting period.

Brent is sitting around 104.42 USD/bbl and WTI around 99.99 USD/bbl, which puts the crude complex in elevated territory rather than a transient spike. The jet fuel series is rising within the reporting period, with the observed figure at 4.341 USD/gal on 9 Sep 2026 versus 4.126 on 8 Sep 2026 (+5.2%).

Some reporting-period benchmarks rose. If suppliers pass those increases through, they could affect freight rates, generator running costs, staff movement and supplier pricing.

SITUATION

The current picture is defined by three linked conditions: chokepoint risk, refinery disruption and shortage. This week's reporting shows those pressures feeding into both benchmark prices and physical fuel availability, rather than remaining a purely financial story.

The market backdrop is firm. Brent and WTI both rose, and jet fuel also rose, which increases transport and aviation cost pressure while supply continuity concerns remain active. The duration and depth of disruption are not yet settled.

WHAT HAPPENED

The most important development was the reported attack on a Saudi refinery on 8 September, which coincided with oil moving above 99 USD and sharpened attention on the Strait of Hormuz as the primary pressure point. That incident matters because refinery disruption in Saudi Arabia has immediate relevance for regional supply sentiment and for the wider crude complex.

Elsewhere, reporting pointed to shortage stress in refined products. In Russia, accounts described a second wave of fuel crisis with long queues and tighter sales limits, while separate reporting said Belarusian refineries posted decade-high profits amid that Russian fuel crisis. Another report said Ukraine hit the Saratov refinery again, adding to pressure around Russian refining and product availability.

A parallel theme was tightening supply of shipping fuel. Reports said ship fuel shortages were looming as war-related disruption strained refiners and refiners favoured other products, including diesel. In India, jet fuel prices were also reported to be surging, increasing pressure on airline cost bases.

OPERATIONAL READ

The main themes right now are chokepoint pressure and tanker-route disruption; fuel shortages; refinery disruption and supply-side outage. Dependent fuel movement could be forced onto longer, costlier routes if the reported disruption constrains transit.

Watch for fresh advisories, vessel reroutes and any naval movement that signals escalation. Watch for rationing rules, allocation cuts to commercial users and convoy or queue management announcements. The reported operational themes are most visible in Iran, Russia and Saudi Arabia.

REGIONAL HIGHLIGHTS

Iran is one of several pressure points right now, with activity spread across the region rather than concentrated in one theatre. Iran was linked to Iran likely to reverse-engineer captured U.S. underwater drone. Route pressure on Hormuz, Bab-el-Mandeb or the Red Sea could feed into bunker cost, transit time and war-risk premium. Watch for fresh advisories, vessel reroutes and any naval movement that signals escalation.

Saudi Arabia is a secondary but credible concern. Saudi Arabia was linked to Oil Surges Past \$99 After Saudi Refinery Attack. A confirmed loss of refinery output could tighten regional product balances and downstream pricing. Watch for restart timelines, force-majeure declarations and follow-on import announcements.

Pakistan adds further weight to the picture. Forecourt and allocation pressure is the confirmed operational signal there. Forecourt shortages could put road transport, staff movement and generator runtime under immediate continuity pressure. Watch for rationing rules, allocation cuts to commercial users and convoy or queue management announcements.

WHAT MATTERS

The operational issue is not only higher fuel costs but the combination of cost pressure with selective disruption to product flows. The Saudi refinery incident raises the sensitivity of crude and refined-product pricing to any further disruption around the Gulf chokepoint, while the shortage reporting points to possible delays in marine bunkering and uneven availability of some products.

Russia stands out for immediate continuity stress because the reporting explicitly mentioned long lines and tighter sales limits. That can translate into slower road movement, more difficult vehicle refuelling and potential disruption to routine staff travel where local supply is already tight. In India, higher jet fuel costs increase pressure on air travel pricing, and the shipping-fuel reporting across South and South-East Asia points to ports and trade lanes where resupply schedules merit closer attention.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Recheck fuel supply assumptions for Gulf-linked routes and cargo movements.
- Confirm alternate bunkering options for voyages touching South Asian and Indonesian ports.
- Review refuelling arrangements and journey planning for road movements in Russia.
- Update aviation cost forecasts to reflect higher jet fuel prices in India.

- Check whether time-critical consignments rely on products affected by refinery disruption.
- Increase monitoring of supplier notices tied to Saudi refining and Russian product availability.

WATCH NEXT

- Any further incident affecting Saudi refining infrastructure
- New disruption or security reporting around the Strait of Hormuz
- Changes in Russian fuel sales limits, queues or regional availability
- Follow-on reporting on Saratov refinery operations and product output
- Port and bunker-market notices
- Further increases in jet fuel pricing pressure affecting Indian aviation

POLESTAR VIEW

Risk level is High. The most likely disruption remains concentrated around Gulf energy flows and in markets already showing shortage stress, with the clearest continuity pressure in Russian road-fuel availability and in marine fuel balances across parts of South and South-East Asia. Prioritise fuel continuity checks, alternate sourcing and route validation where movements depend on Gulf supply exposure, Russian domestic fuel access or bunkering availability.

RELATED INCIDENTS

DATE	TYPE	TITLE	SEVERITY
11 Sep 2026	Vessel attack	IRGC Says Iranian Navy Attacked U.S. Unmanned Vessel in Strait of Hormuz Vessel attack, reported 11 Sep 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
11 Sep 2026	Chokepoint risk	Houthi Rebels Seize Key Port City Near Bab el-Mandeb Strait in New Attacks Chokepoint risk, reported 11 Sep 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
11 Sep 2026	Load shedding	One unit of Adani power plant shuts down, exacerbating load-shedding Load shedding, reported 11 Sep 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
11 Sep 2026	Load shedding	Sudden Shutdown of Multiple Power Plants Worsens Load-Shedding Load shedding, reported 11 Sep 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
11 Sep 2026	Load shedding	Simkot residents face 22 hours of daily load-shedding Load shedding, reported 11 Sep 2026, assessed at Low severity.	LOW

DATE	TYPE	TITLE	SEVERITY
10 Sep 2026	Chokepoint risk	Iran claims it struck US unmanned surveillance vessel in Strait of Hormuz Chokepoint risk, reported 10 Sep 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
09 Sep 2026	Chokepoint risk	Iran likely to reverse-engineer captured U.S. underwater drone Chokepoint risk in Strait of Hormuz, reported 09 Sep 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
09 Sep 2026	Fuel shortage	Dangote Says Global Fuel Shortage Could Outlast Iran War Fuel shortage, reported 09 Sep 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
09 Sep 2026	Load shedding	Load shedding: Devastation caused by the five Pandavas Load shedding, reported 09 Sep 2026, assessed at Low severity.	LOW
08 Sep 2026	Refinery disruption	Ukraine Hits Saratov Refinery Again as Russian Fuel Crisis Deepens Refinery disruption, reported 08 Sep 2026, assessed at Low severity.	LOW
08 Sep 2026	Refinery disruption	Oil Surges Past \$99 After Saudi Refinery Attack Refinery disruption, reported 08 Sep 2026, assessed at High severity.	HIGH
08 Sep 2026	Fuel shortage	Ship fuel shortage looms as refiners strained by war favour other products Fuel shortage, reported 08 Sep 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
07 Sep 2026	Fuel shortage	Global ship fuel shortage looms as war disruptions squeeze refinery output Fuel shortage, reported 07 Sep 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
07 Sep 2026	Fuel shortage	Shipping Fuel Shortage Looms as Refiners Prioritize Diesel Fuel shortage, reported 07 Sep 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE

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